

CS 4885-5885

Comments on Proposal Papers

Most proposals look good, but some may be improved. A lot of you have read relevant literature and thought seriously about your projects. F

You can make all corrections and resubmit the paper in a week for improved grade. Please attach the version where I made notations so I know what to look for. I want all of you to become good technical writers by the end of the semester.

General comments:

1. Use the AAAI format. Some of you have created your own format, but it's not acceptable.. The fonts must be consistent. The references must be in AAAI style: (author year), (author1 and author2 year), (author et al. year), etc.. All author names are last names. No need of writing out the title of a paper in the actual text of your document. Don't mix citation styles: [nn] and (author and author year). Don't use something like "Author1 and Author2 (author1 and author2, yyyy) mention".
2. Do not refer to the same paper over and over again, especially in close proximity.
3. Reference items must be complete. That is, need title of paper, title of journal, year, volume, issue, page numbers, etc. For conference papers, need full name of conference, page numbers and location of conference. Books need publisher and year. Just copying from Google Scholar may not give you all details. You may have to search Google to find all required details. For arxiv.org papers, it is preferable that you find out where they were actually published, if they were. Arxiv.org is considered self-publication and therefore, the mix of papers is sometimes terrible and sometimes great, and everything in between.
4. All equations, tables and figures must have numbers and captions. They must be referred to in the paper by number, not by saying table (equation or figure) above or below.
5. Avoid using 'I', 'my', 'you', etc., in formal papers. You can use some 'we', 'our', etc. It is best to use to active voice, although some passive may be OK, but passives shouldn't become a habit. Avoid using words like 'basically', 'so', etc., unless absolutely necessary.
6. Sentences ending in equations and lists must also end with a period.
7. Redraw images if you can; if you use someone else's image, provide source in the caption. However, I don't like it if you have 5 figures in your paper, and all of them are copied from somewhere.
8. English needs to be well-edited.
9. Do not have paragraphs that are too short, say 1 or 2 sentences. Paragraphs throughout the paper should be more or less balanced in size.

Contents:

1. As I said before, try to attack an interesting problem with a recent architecture/approach.
2. Do not use colloquial language.

3. Spelling and grammatical errors not acceptable. One or two here and there are normal, but nothing beyond that.
4. Must have technical content, everything cannot be at a high level!
5. You cannot make domain specific statements that are not obvious, without references or experimental results, etc. Opinions are normally not allowed, unless backed by evidence.
6. Copying of any kind from any source is not allowed. Small amount (say a phrase or a sentence) may be copied, written in quotes with proper mention to source.
7. The abstract should be a summary of your work, but a summary that is in some ways a marketing tool, highlighting your achievements.
8. Need to have a section called "Related Work" or "Previous Work" or such. Need to read recent papers (say, after 2023-4) and also highly cited papers. Needed 5 papers for the proposal. Need 10 papers for mid-term.
9. Need a section called "Conclusions" or something similar the end. You can summarize the paper here.
10. Please give some more details about the algorithms/architecture(s) you will use, instead of saying "convolutional neural networks" or "Q learning", etc., in general terms. Identify one or more techniques, although you are not sure at this time, but use your best judgment.
11. In particular, try to provide at least one (architecture/approach) diagram in your paper.
12. Datasets: Machine learning requires datasets, RL may or may not. If you are going to use downloaded data, say from where and describe the data. If you are going to create data, say how. Datasets can be a bottleneck, and so if you are going to create your datasets, please start thinking about it right away.
13. Timeline: Need to break up your problem into several steps and provide a time estimate for each in the proposal.
14. Evaluation: You must evaluate your results. Start thinking about metrics to use, and describe these metrics briefly. What kinds of experiments are you going to run for evaluation?
15. Learn to use BibTeX for references.
16. Try to have references from recent papers in conferences like CVPR, ECCV, NIPS, AAAI, ACL, NAACL, COLING.
17. Midterm: Expect to see algorithms, equations, details of experiments carried out, evaluation, analysis in terms of tables and graphs, further work.